
OpenWA Easy API Setup

A beginner-friendly way to connect WhatsApp to OpenWA locally without building a custom app first.

This guide uses OpenWA's ready-made Easy API flow. You install Node.js once, run one command, complete the WhatsApp login step on your phone, and open a local browser page that shows the available actions.

How It Works

- Node.js is the engine that lets your computer run OpenWA.
- OpenWA starts a local WhatsApp automation session on your computer.
- WhatsApp login connects that local session after you scan the QR code or follow the login method shown in the terminal.
- Easy API gives you a browser page where you can inspect and test WhatsApp actions.

Manual Work Still Required

The assistant can prepare instructions, but you still need to do these parts yourself.

1. Install Node.js LTS if it is not already installed.
2. Run the OpenWA command in a terminal.
3. Complete the WhatsApp login step from your phone.
4. Keep the terminal open while OpenWA is running.

Local-only setup: Keep this beginner setup on your own computer. Do not expose the OpenWA API to the public internet unless you understand how to secure it.

Prompt for Codex or Claude Code

Paste this into your coding assistant if you want it to prepare the local setup instructions for you.

I am not a coder. Set up the simplest local OpenWA Easy API starter in the current folder for me.

Use the official OpenWA Easy API route.

Do not create a custom WhatsApp bot, index.js file, Express server, or package.json unless the official Easy API cannot handle this basic setup.

Use this stable first-run command:

```
npx @open-wa/wa-automate@4.76.0 --port 8080
```

Please do the following:

1. Check whether Node.js and npm are installed.
2. If Node.js or npm is missing, stop and tell me to install the LTS version of Node.js from the official Node.js website.
3. Create a short beginner-friendly README in this folder.
4. In the README, include:
 - the exact command to start OpenWA
 - how to stop it
 - how to restart it
 - how to scan the WhatsApp login QR code
 - how to open the local API docs page in the browser
5. Keep this setup local only.
6. Do not expose it to the public internet.
7. Do not add a webhook unless I provide a webhook URL.
8. At the end, tell me only the manual steps I still need to do in simple English.

Do not assume I know coding.

Do not leave me with missing steps.

Step-by-Step Setup

Follow these steps in order. You do not need to write code; you only need to install Node.js, paste one command, and scan the login QR code.

STEP 1

Install Node.js

Open the official Node.js download page and install the version marked LTS.

<https://nodejs.org/en/download>

Use the normal installer and keep the default options.

STEP 2

Open a Terminal

Open Terminal on Mac or Command Prompt / PowerShell on Windows.

You do not need to write code. You only need to paste the start command.

STEP 3

Start OpenWA Easy API

Paste this command and press Enter.

```
npx @open-wa/wa-automate@4.76.0 --port 8080
```

Your computer downloads what it needs and starts OpenWA locally.

STEP 4

Connect WhatsApp

Wait for the terminal to show the login step. If it shows a QR code, scan it from WhatsApp on your phone.

1. Open WhatsApp.
2. Go to Linked Devices.
3. Tap Link a Device.
4. Scan the QR code on your computer screen.

If the terminal shows a different login method, follow the method displayed there.

Finish and Use the Local API

STEP 5

Open the Local API Page

After WhatsApp connects, open your browser and go here.

```
http://localhost:8080/api-docs/
```

This local page shows the OpenWA actions available for testing.

STEP 6

Test Carefully

Use your own number first for any message test. Start with one small test before connecting other tools.

STEP 7

Keep It Running

Leave the terminal open while you use OpenWA. Closing the terminal stops the running session.

STEP 8

Stop or Restart Later

To stop OpenWA, click the terminal and press:

```
Ctrl + C
```

To start again later, run the same OpenWA command again.

Optional Webhook Setup

If you later receive a webhook URL from an automation tool, add it only when you are ready to use it.

```
npx @open-wa/wa-automate@4.76.0 --port 8080 --webhook  
"PASTE_YOUR_WEBHOOK_URL_HERE"
```

Quick Checklist

1. Install Node.js LTS.
2. Run the OpenWA Easy API command.
3. Complete WhatsApp login from your phone.
4. Open <http://localhost:8080/api-docs/>.
5. Keep the terminal running while you use OpenWA.

Official links: OpenWA project: <https://github.com/open-wa/wa-automate-nodejs>; Node.js downloads: <https://nodejs.org/en/download>.